

THE AIMS OF MARK:

most importantly, Mark's narrative was concerned to show Jesus as teacher, prophet and divine man and to provide a concrete base for the three-fold role of Jesus in the faith of the church

Seconded to encourage people would come

to hang d for salvation

third, it was written to forewarn those who were falling away or **indifferent** because of the delay of the parousia, the second coming.

finally, it was mediator of the church's worship of God--this provided materials that could be used in worship of the early church.

336-339
316-3327
pastorals
340-346

it is probable that the synoptic tradition could be as early as Paul's writings (the earliest we have) but was not written down till there was a threat to the church's existence by the death of the original eyewitnesses and the fact the parousia had not occurred.

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Mark attempts to answer the following questions.

1.

cross,

there had to be a reason for Jesus' shameful death on the cross, what was it?

2. where had authority for his re-interpretation of the law of Moses come from?

3. where did he derive power to perform miracles and exorcisms?

4. How does the New Covenant relate to the old, and how could his followers claim him to be the fulfillment of Jewish scripture?

5. How has God prepared the chain of events leading up to Jesus being disclosed as the vindicated and vindicating son of

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Mark begins with Jesus' baptism by John in the Jordan and says nothing about his birth or pre-existence.

Jesus is just one of the crowd coming to John and hearing the voice of God is a private experience, in keeping with the

messianic secret .

Mark 1:24 begins his ministry by performing an exorcism at the
this is to show first off, his power over
synagoge at Capernaum.

Satan

by teaching, Mark means far more than merely the message of
Jesus: it encompasses the whole of his public activity.

its chief characteristic is that it is authoritative, not in
the sense that it carries the sanctions of the appropriated
religious officials, since it is the opposite of this, but that
it brings its own conviction.

Look at

in healing the paralytic (Mark 2:10) Mark shows that Jesus has
the power to forgive sins, which is the eschatological power of
the son of man even before the New Age has fully come .
there are many places in Mark that are more concerned with what
was happening in the church in 68 or following, when Mark was
written than with what Jesus actually said.

Look a

one example is fasting (2:18-22) , where there is
justification for why Jesus' disciples didn't fast but why the
church did, because the bridegroom had been taken away from them

#2

(2:20) an interpretation that was probably added by Mark.

in 3:28 Mark is dealing with questions in the church about which
sins are forgivable? and how does the Church regard someone who
attributes to Satan what is in fact the work of the Holy Spirit?
Mark 4 deals with Jesus calming the storm on the sea of Galilee.

Mark wants his readers to know that Jesus is the agent of
God's rule over the whole cosmos, not merely over human needs.

but his question "have you no faith?" is addressed to the
church of Mark's day as well as the disciples.

feeding, the 5000 and walking on water (mark 6:30-56)

are

intended to attribute cosmic power to Jesus.

starting with Mark 8:31 there are three increasingly detailed
predictions of the suffering, death and resurrection of Jesus.

(9:31 and 10:33-34 are the others.)

there is no direct logical significance assigned by Mark to
suffering but it is rather inevitable if the redemptive outcome
is to occur .

two questions concerned the church Mark was part of about life in
the age to come.

Mark 10

Marriage and divorce to this Mark has Jesus reply that God intended man and woman to be inseparably united so divorce is a concession to human weakness, not a divine provision.

Mark adds further (10:10) the arguments against man or taking the initiative in divorce.

Woman

#33

he used the roman rule that either could initiate divorce, which women could not in Judaism while **Matthew**, the Jewish gospel, kept with the Jewish understanding that only the man could initiate divorce.

the second question had to do with riches and the kingdom.

it became the occasion for the denunciation of riches on the ground that man cannot differentiate between what he has acquired and his own self-esteem.

it is not how a man ranks on the achievement scale of the divine commandments or in the acquisition of wealth that is the essential question, but the intensity of his commitment to the work of preparing men for the Kingdom of God (10:17-31)

Mark, unlike the later two gospels dependent on him, has Jesus proclaimed as one who comes in the Lord's name based on Psalm 118:26, which was quoted in Jesus day as the eschatological hope of the establishment of God's Kingdom.

Matt. has Jesus proclaimed as king when he enters Jerusalem on Palm Sunday (Mt. 21:9) as does Luke (Lk 19:28-44)
The Little Apocalypse Mark 13 - look at

the editorial hand of Mark is seen in the shift from the public pronouncement of the Temple's impending destruction (13:1-2) to the private explanation to the disciples.

Marks key to when the end WILL

be is the desecration

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Temple (13:14)

although there is no way of knowing when the end will come the

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new covenant people can be sure that it will occur within the life of the first generation of its members.

(13:30)

it is the responsibility of the community to be ever faithful and watchful (13:35-37)

the language and view of this discourse is heavily dependent on Daniel. gr

the other synoptic writers have expanded this part of Mark, drawing largely from the Q material but the basic structure and place of the discourse in the overall picture of Jesus' career is Mark's contribution,

Mark wants his readers to see a parallel between the desecration of the temple in Daniel's (Maccabean) times and the destruction of the Temple predicted by Jesus.

Mark is saying that what was expected in Daniel didn't occur but that it is now about to take place.

this destruction of the temple is the best clue to the historical circumstances for the writing of Mark.

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Just as the Maccabean crisis in the days of Antiochus IV led to the writing of Daniel, so the Roman invasion of Palestine beginning in 66 CE led to the writing of Mark.

Last Supper and New Covenant

look at: Mark 14:25 clearly implies that the church recalled the last supper as first, an analogy between the Jewish passover and the death of Jesus and second, the concept of Jesus death as the sacrifice that sealed the New Covenant promised in Jeremiah 31.

Mark's interpretation was not a full developed theological

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explanation of the death of Jesus; it declares only that, the li fa ("blood" was equivalent to li

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linked with the (new) covenant and was to the benefit of

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Condemnation and death

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but the oldest and best manuscripts end at 16:8.

Mark had Jesus instruc the reader what the final outcome will
be several times **so** it is possible he leaves this to their own
faith.

GOSPEL OF MATTHEW

we have already mentioned some things about Matthew's
gospel but I want to cover some more.

Christianity is for Matt. the divinely disclosed fulfillment
of the Law and of the Jewish hopes.

He cannot comprehend that those who stand in the
tradition of the Law could fail to discern the truth **as** it
is in **Jesus**.

a fitting characterization of the book is it is a manual of
church instruction and administration comparable to the

Manuel of Discipline found in the dead sea **scrolls**-
there seems to be a conscious five fold construction of the
central section of the book, perhaps a conscious imitation
of the five books of the torah.

Matt. seems to be showing that it is precisely the Law
and the prophets that have their fulfillment in Jesus.

#7

Matthew reproduced nearly **all of the miracle** stories found
in **his** sources **Mark and Q**.

often he heightens the **miraculous element** and haveing
the rulers daughter **dead, not just near death** as in Mark.

for the most part, the changes in the **miracle** stories
serve his **theological** purpose **by** concentrating **on the faith**
of the **persons** healed, **or on the authority of Jesus**, or on
the **demands of** discipleship.

for example, **at the** resurrection Mark soberly **describes the**
stone **as already** rolled **back and a young man** present **who**
announces that Jesus has been **raised from the** dead.

Mat. reports a great **earthquake, an angel** descending
from heaven, and terror **that** strikes **down the** guards.

Matt. attitude toward the **law can be** seen in two **passages**.

look at: 5:17 think not that I **have come to abolish the law and**
the prophets, I have come not to abolish them but to fulfill
them. for truly, I say to you, till heaven and earth pass
away, not an iota, not a dot, will pass from the law until
all is accomplished.

and **in the series of** antitheses **"you have heard that it was**
said to the **men of old**.

but I **say** to you.

Matthew is convinced **that what** has been wrong **with the**
nation that called itself Israel is that **it has** not in the
proper **and complete way** expected the **Law to be** fulfilled;

now the **new community for** which he is the spokesman
looks forward to the true and total **accomplishment of**
everything **promised and commanded in the law**.

sees the role of the member of the community as
twofold,; doing **and** teaching.

unlike the pharasees who
teach but do not live rightly, the true child of the Kingdom
teaches rightly and lives rightly.

the bottom line is one must be perfect **as** your heavenly
father is perfect (Matt. 5:48)

this does **not** meant the absence **of moral** perfection but

the wholeness and singlemindedness **by which** God goes **about fulfilling his** purposes and **by which standard man is called to obey him.**

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look at:

Luke 6:36 has toned down the force of this demand in his parallel form of this saying by substituting the word "merciful". but **Matt** is closer to what was likely the original intent of **Jesus'** word.

THE WAY OF RIGHTOUSNESS

a characteristic term of Matthew is righteousness.

this is laid down at the beginning of **Jesus'** ministry when he tells John that he must baptize him to fulfill all **Jesus** is presented thruout the gospel as the righteousness..

embodiment of righteousness.

In **6:33** the kingdom of Heaven and righteousness are linked only when God's goals are fulfilled in history when the kingdom has come in its fullness- will the "way of righteousness" reach its divinely determined end..

look at **Matt:25:31-46** in the parable of the last judgement shows **Matt.** blending of eschatology and ethics.

human behavior is

the prime criterion in God's action to effect the consummation of history.

the way of righteousness is not a path of legalism, by which the commandments are obeyed in order to "keep the rules".

It is a way of life according to which the commandment to is put into concrete action.

10

look at

It is not the one who says **Lord, Lord (Mat. 7:21)** but the one who does the **Father's will** who enters the kingdom
EXPECTATIONS OF THE END

only **Matt.** has **John** the baptist proclaim the nearness of the kingdom of heaven, and only **Matt.** among the synoptics has **John** aware of **Jesus** sonship at the moment of his baptism (**Matt. 3:16**)

from various parts of **Mark** and **Q** **Matt.** has brought together a series of sayings which he has modified in order to point up one of his major themes, the coming (parousia) of the son of Man (**Matt. 24**)

he does hint that the interval between the first and second

coming **may** be a long period. meanwhile, the followrs of Jesus are **to preach** the gospel **and** instruct all **people of** the world.

there is **some very vindictive** pronouncements against the pharasees and Israel which **reflect** the **situation** of direct **conflict between** Israel and the growing **church** and **with** Rome **and** the Church.

these tell **us more** about Mathew and his **atitudes** **than** about **Jesus**.

the irony in Matt. view is not that he denounces the Jews **but** that he expects the church to take over so much of the Jewish institutions and practice:

scribal

intterpretations,, cerimonial requiriments, alms, fasting and **so** on.

the church is for him the true Israel which takes the **place** of the **nation** whisab did **not** see **in** Jesus **God's**

Messiah.

LUKE

matt did not set forth a theory of the whole sweep of history by which the church could understand itself and its reason for existence in the interim before the coming of the end of the age. Howey, Luke did **so**

in Lukes view the establishment of the church was much a part of the fulfillment **of** the divine plan as the act of consummation itself.

the age of the church is the midpoint in the whole drama

Luke's understanding is an ambitious one. he wants to place the ministry of Jesus and the work of the church in the context of the universal purpose of God.

there are three epochs for Luke:

1. from ancient Israel to John the Baptist.

for Matt John marks the beginning of the new era **but** for Luke, John marks the end of the epoch of the Law and the prophets

Luke

"the law and the prophets were until John; since then the good news of the kingdom of God is preached, and every one enters it violently (Luke 16:16)

Luke is also careful to show that the ministry of Jesus is in fulfillment of scripture. Look at Luke 4:16-30

the second epoch is the earthly ministry of Jesus which is divided into three phases

first, the launching of his ministry in Galilee, gathering his disciples there the 12, representing the 12 tribes of Israel. this concludes in Luke 9:49ff

second was the ministry to those outside of Galilee

in this he sends out the 70 which represents all the nations then known so the number is symbolic.

the third takes place in Jerusalem which is central in Luke's thinking to the whole redemptive purpose of God

the resurrection appearances take place in Jerusalem while Mat and Mark have them in Galilee. (in Mark, only alluded to).

the third epoch is from the ascension to the return of Christ.

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ascension is reported only by Luke In acts 1 and marks the transition to the third epoch.

it does not matter then how long the Last Day may be delayed; the ground of redemptive activity has been laid in the work of Jesus Christ in fulfillment of the Law and the prophets.

thus Luke is much more open than the other synoptics to women, the poor, the outcast.

not only is God willing to accept those who are estranged from him and to forgive those who are grievous sinners, but that he is actively seeking out those who are far from him, whether jews who were excluded from the life of the covenant or gentiles who never had a part in the covenant.

look at.

Luke underscores this in 15:1-32 in three parables, the lost sheep, coin and boy.

Luke, of the synoptics, is by far the most inclusive.

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